



Siddharth Zarabi (left) with Nimesh Arora, CEO & Chairman of Palo Alto Networks



Roshni Nadar Malhotra, Chairperson of HCL Technologies



Byju Raveendran, Founder and CEO of BYJU'S

ALMOST SIX IN 10 CEOs POLLED BY PwC SHOWED OPTIMISM ABOUT INDIA'S ECONOMY OVER THE NEXT 12 MONTHS

And when it comes to new investments, India will see a crucial step being taken by the Vedanta-Foxconn combine for its proposed \$19.5-billion semiconductor manufacturing plant in Gujarat. Vedanta Chairman Anil Agarwal said the joint venture hoped to break ground for the mega plant in just over a month. "We have all the tie-ups with Inolex, Foxconn and hope that in two and a half years, we will sell chips (semiconductors) to India and the rest of the world," he said.

And it is not just brick-and-mortar businesses that had a field day at Davos. Fintech behemoth Paytm Founder Vijay Shekhar Sharma said the company, whose share price took a severe beating after going public, would become profitable by the September quarter this year. "I formally put September 2023 as a quarter which is going to be profitable. This [profitability] will happen way earlier than the timeline that I am giving you. We are very proud to say this is happening by not sacrificing any investment that we are making, or any growth that we could have captured," said Sharma.

Just like the India Lounge brought relief to many a hungry delegate this year, the Indian economy is seen as a ray of hope for the world amid fears of an impending recession. **BT**

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